

Drue Wilding

Test Automation Engineer

2300 Copenhagen S, Denmark

+45 71 45 45 64

drue@wilding.dk

linkedin.com/in/druewilding

github.com/druewilding

A quality engineer with a decade-plus track record building test automation frameworks and CI/CD pipelines, plus hands-on backend development experience. I've built testing tooling for media broadcast infrastructure, e-commerce platforms and health tech; always with a focus on making systems testable, observable, and reliable under real-world load. I thrive working closely with engineers from other disciplines and taking ownership of quality end-to-end.

Technical Profile

Test Automation & Quality Engineering: Playwright, Detox, Cucumber, Gatling, CI/CD pipeline design and ownership

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, Ruby, Scala, Bash, plus working knowledge of C# and Python

Backend & Architecture: Microservices, REST APIs, worker/queue patterns, event-driven systems

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis

DevOps & Infrastructure: Docker, Kubernetes, Scalingo, AWS, Azure, Windows & Linux environments

Core Competencies

- ▶ **Test automation frameworks:** Designing and maintaining scalable, reusable automated test suites and shared testing libraries across multiple teams and products
- ▶ **CI/CD ownership:** Building and monitoring pipelines, triaging failures, and coordinating fixes with engineering teams
- ▶ **Performance & reliability engineering:** Load testing, benchmarking, and capacity planning to find and push system limits before they fail in production
- ▶ **Cross-functional collaboration:** Extensive experience working alongside engineers from adjacent disciplines to define and validate system behaviour
- ▶ **Quality by design:** Building testability and observability into systems from the start
- ▶ **Fast learner:** Comfortable switching technology stacks; proven track record across Ruby, Node.js, Scala, Python

Work History

November 2023 – Present: Backend Developer & Test Specialist at Hedia, Copenhagen, Denmark

Testing & quality engineering:

- ▶ Designed and maintained end-to-end test suites across backend services (Playwright) and mobile apps (Detox, iOS + Android).
- ▶ Performance/stress testing with Gatling, identifying capacity limits under load.
- ▶ Built and maintained CI/CD pipelines in GitHub Actions for testing, release, and deployment automation.
- ▶ Created shared testing frameworks and taught others how to use them.

Backend development & architecture:

- ▶ Designed and implemented a Redis-backed queue architecture (web+worker pattern) to handle traffic spikes. Reduced API response times from seconds to sub-millisecond, eliminated error spikes, and enabled horizontal scaling.
- ▶ Built an analytics service from scratch: PostgreSQL materialized views over 34M events, REST API, SSO authentication, deployed as independent microservice.
- ▶ Optimized PostgreSQL queries on large datasets. Composite indexing improved aggregation performance.
- ▶ Implemented microservice routing via reverse proxy configuration, managing CSP and content policies.
- ▶ Built automated data pipelines with nightly refresh via GitHub Actions.

February 2023 – October 2023: Senior QA Engineer at Planday, Copenhagen, Denmark

- ▶ Developed a shared testing framework using Playwright and Axios, published as NPM packages for cross-team use.
- ▶ Set up automated testing on review environments via CI/CD workflows.
- ▶ Advocated for and implemented conventional commits, standard release processes, and code quality tooling.
- ▶ Proposed TypeScript best practices and testing standards for adoption across teams.

August 2018 – February 2023: QA Coordinator at Danmarks Radio, Copenhagen, Denmark

- ▶ Introduced automated testing across functional, performance, load, security, and accessibility domains.
- ▶ Built tooling that made it easy for developers to write and run their own tests.
- ▶ Used Gatling to simulate hundreds of thousands of concurrent users for load testing DR's digital platforms, including the DRTV streaming site and election results pages.

April 2013 – August 2018: Senior Tester at BBC, London, UK

- ▶ Built a test framework that emulated a physical Chromecast device to verify HTML video player integration without needing the real hardware on hand — an early example of building test setups to validate software against a hardware target.
- ▶ Pioneered automated testing for media technologies previously considered untestable, including high-throughput, high-availability infrastructure for video/audio transcoding and playback — systems with hard real-time and hardware-adjacent constraints.
- ▶ Ensured reliability during high-profile live events under fixed deadlines with no room for failure (Olympics, national elections).
- ▶ Line managed a team of 8, providing technical leadership and mentoring.

March 2011 – April 2013: Software Developer at Aimee Rivers Ltd, UK

- ▶ Built Ruby on Rails applications and mobile solutions for diverse clients.
- ▶ Developed the first Android version of BufferApp.
- ▶ Delivered projects across varying scales, adapting quickly to new technologies and domains.

June 2008 – March 2011: Software Developer at Eden Development, Winchester, UK

- ▶ Ruby on Rails application development in a consultancy environment.
- ▶ Foundational training in TDD, BDD, and clean code principles.
- ▶ Agile development practices in a collaborative startup team.

Education

1999 – 2002: BSc (Hons) Computer Science, University of Portsmouth, UK

Languages

English: Native speaker; **Danish:** Proficient (C2)